



Google discontinuing Street View
Google has plans to discontinue its dedicated Street View app on Android next year. <https://digit.in/nov22-13>



iOS 16 5G Beta soon
Apple will enable 5G in the iOS 16 Beta software programme soon for select users in the country. <https://digit.in/nov22-14>

The best in tech

“The greatest ever”... really?

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The last few months have been packed with tech launches. I am seeing gadgets go in and out of the Digit Test Centre like it is a saloon in America before prohibition. And, the best part for people like me, is that almost none of the products are impressive enough to blow our minds. In September we had Apple’s ‘Far Out’ event where they truly went far and out to display how clueless they are. Their marquee phone wasn’t optimised and as usual had a ton of features renamed to hype things up. Then, one fine day, on a dull Saturday when I was about to head out of the Test Centre, the NVIDIA RTX 4090 showed up. Team green by then had already announced the product and it had started showing up on the social media handles of many creators overseas. When it came to us after a long time, I was impressed by the unboxing experience. They had put in thought into the packaging, making it into something that any tech enthusiast would appreciate.

However, once our eager reviewers had ripped the whole outer packaging apart, out came the mammoth card. Everyone was astonished by the size of this inferno that was going to burn a massive hole in most of these people’s pockets. But, I stood there in thought. There were a million questions running through my mind at the time, with the most prominent one being, is it worth the size? The case that I have definitely wouldn’t fit it. And, IF I dare to throw it into my system, without a proper sup-

porting bracket in place for the card, then it would rip the PCIe slot off the board. While we see tech getting smaller by the day, why is it so that the GPUs are getting bigger by the day. Just look at the pictures that are there on the internet. I know that it is a meme that you’d have come across a million times if you are on the PCMR subreddit. But, it does invoke a thought. At least, it did for me. I don’t know about other simpletons that seem to be raging in all their glory on the internet. Yes, I am talking to you PCMR expert Simon. I am sure I will get a couple of emails with the following argument “It Is wOrth thE IncrEAsEd sIzE bEcAuSE It pEr-fOrms bEtter...”

But, I want Simon and everyone else to spare a thought. At what point do you say no to the increasing prices and size of tech, which is the most important thing in this case? The case that I am using (pun NOT intended) will need to be changed, which means I will have to spend money there. An additional expense

would be the anti-sag support. Yes, I am calling it that. Both these things put together will set me back atleast a quarter of the cost of the card itself. That is, provided I am not going all guns blazing on the case choice.

At 1080p, the performance numbers of the RTX 4090 were great. After looking at these numbers, the head of the Test Center where I work, wrote “...from what we’ve seen thus far, it seems like the RTX 4090 will have a similarly impressive performance gap over the previous gen GPUs.” That is true. But...

I do not want to lash out at the makers of the card. I know the consumers demand the best of the best from them. So, they are left with no choice but to give them the best of what they can make at the time. In this case, it leads to more heat being generated and the size of the cooling system being increased. But there has to be a point where we are content with what we have. And, I just want to know - To what lengths will we go to, in order to fulfil the inherent urge of buying and experiencing “the best in tech”?

It might seem to you that age has finally caught up to me. But, in reality, it is nothing like that. I believe, it is more of being bombarded with the “best in tech” by anyone and everyone that I am sure has caught up to many members of the tech community. Last month, the SKOAR! cover story covered the near death experience of AA games to the hands of AAA games. And, I am sure that there will be a time when everyone will be making the greatest ever piece of tech and everyone except the top rung of the community will feel left out. It is that time of the year when we have festivals around us, meaning we have some time off to slow down during one of those days and spare a thought. If you have something that you come up with, feel free to share that with me at booman@digit.in. **d**

Game @1080p (RTX 4090)	FPS
Assassin’s Creed Valhalla	182
Battlefield V	213
Borderlands 3	95
CIV VI	311
Control	231
Cyberpunk 2077	135
Doom Eternal	483
F1 2022	295
HITMAN 3	131
Metro Exodus	240
Cyberpunk 2077	135
Cyberpunk 2077 RTX	81